

Nightmare Chimera

For many Seelie changelings, the Dreaming is a place of wonder and magic, where fantastic creatures can be found, befriended, and tamed. Kittens lounge in front of balefires, stables are filled with fairy horses, and nocker labs produce amazing steampunk creatures of brasswork and ticking gears. Even the Unseelie, with their darker dreams, sometimes forget that worse things lurk in the Dreaming than their aggressive constructs and breath-stealing toms.

Nightmares are just as common as, and usually more powerful than, daydreams. For every fluffy bunny or twittering flock of songbirds, a lean and hungry monster waits with slaving jaws and gleaming eyes. Wild beasts and terrifying threats hunt in the Nightmare, crossing over to the Dreaming and the mundane world with seeming impunity, seeking mortal dreams and Kithain Glamour to slake their appetites. Some nightmare chimera are ancient fears, remnants from the deepest corners of civilized memory. Others are so new and bizarre, their authenticity has yet to be confirmed.

Though these dark and hostile chimera have been categorized in many ways over the centuries, their contemporary classifications fall into four broad groups: *feral chimera*, *nervosa*, *nocnitsa*, and *urban legends*.

Feral Chimera

Feral chimera come about in two ways. Some are birthed chimera, emerging fully-formed from the minds of Dreamers to haunt the trods and glades of the Near Dreaming. Many are orphan chimera, pets and companions that used to belong to someone and, through misfortune or malice, were separated from their Kithain masters and forced to survive on their own.

Most feral chimera are the Dreaming's counterparts to mundane wild animals: rabbits, cats, wolves, horses, etc. To those lucky (or unfortunate) enough to see them, feral chimera always possess eerie and haunting features that mark them as *other*, and many have been the inspiration for tales of demon animals throughout the world's mythology.

Fairy Cats

Some are Dreamed chimera, but most fairy cats encountered along the trods have been separated from their owners and left to fend for themselves against the madness of the Dreaming. Every open window, door left ajar, and hole in the wall provides an opportunity for escape. A kitten gets separated from her sidhe child. A boggan's prized mouser doesn't come back from wandering one night. A pampered lap cat is lost on the trods as her eshu moves between freeholds.

Fairy cats vary in appearance. Some are almost indiscernible from mundane cats, but close inspection reveals extra-long claws and weirdly glowing eyes. Others are fantastic colors with exaggerated features that linger long after the cat itself has disappeared. Very rarely, a changeling may encounter true *cait sith*, huge, black felines of wild magic from the Deep Dreaming.

Attributes: Strength 1, Dexterity 4, Stamina 3, Perception 3, Intelligence 2, Wits 2

Abilities: Alertness 2, Athletics 4, Brawl 2, Empathy 1, Kenning 1, Stealth 3, Survival 2

Health Levels: OK, OK, OK, -5, Incapacitated

Redes: Hide

Glamour: 4 **Willpower:** 1

Armor: 0 (3 soak dice, total)

Attack: Claw/3 dice lethal; Bite/3 dice lethal

Cù Sìth

Also known as *cŵn annwn*, black dogs, hellhounds, and *sidhe-dogs*, *cù sìth* are harbingers of fate and the hounds of the Wild Hunt. On Samhain, they are unleashed to run down their prey, harrying mortals into enchantment and changelings into Bedlam. When the sun comes up, they vanish like smoke, leaving behind next to no evidence they were ever there.

Cù sìth are enormous dogs resembling heavily-muscled mastiffs, with thick black, green, or white fur, glowing eyes, and razor-sharp teeth. Their paw prints burn into solid rock, yet leave no trace on grass or dirt, and their howls strike fear into the most courageous of hearts. *Cù sìth* are territorial, guarding their dens as fiercely as the tombs of kings.

Attributes: Strength 5, Dexterity 3, Stamina 5, Perception 3, Intelligence 2, Wits 3

Abilities: Alertness 3, Athletics 3, Brawl 3, Empathy 2, Intimidation (Inspire Terror) 4, Kenning 2, Survival (Tracking by Scent) 4

Health Levels: OK, OK, OK, -1, -1, -2, -2, -5, Incapacitated

Redes: Armor (x3), Enchantment, Fear

Glamour: 5 **Willpower:** 1

Armor Rating: 3 (8 soak dice, total)

Attack: Bite/6 dice lethal

Hellsteed

When the devil rides, he mounts a hellsteed. Also known as black unicorns, Diomedan chargers, night mares, and demon horses, hellsteeds have haunted humanity's dreams for millennia. The masters of the fairy raed—the Wild Hunt—ride coal-black horses that can steal a person's soul. The Four Horsemen bring about the Apocalypse while mounted on unearthly horses. Even the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow sits astride a demon mount with smoldering hooves and fiery red eyes.

Wild hellsteeds are exceptionally rare encounters in the Near Dreaming, even for those souls brave enough to trespass near nightmare trods. On certain nights of the year, when the barriers between the worlds are thin, hellsteeds can appear to mortals, giving rise to legends of flesheating mares, flying stallions, unicorns, and horses with flaming manes.

Attributes: Strength 7, Dexterity 5, Stamina 6, Perception 4, Intelligence 4, Wits 4

Abilities: Alertness 4, Athletics (Running) 5, Brawl (Kicks) 5, Empathy 3, Intimidation (Silent Threats) 5, Kenning (Trods) 4, Survival (Tracking) 4